

# 42 Reporting with passives

One way to distance yourself from facts is to use the passive voice and reporting verbs. This device is commonly used in newspaper and television journalism.

⚙️ **New language** Passive voice for reporting

Aa **Vocabulary** Reporting language

🧑 **New skill** Distancing yourself from facts

## 42.1 KEY LANGUAGE REPORTING WITH PASSIVES

A number of structures and reporting verbs can be used in the passive voice to distance the writer or speaker from the facts.

"IT" + PASSIVE REPORTING VERB

"THAT" CLAUSE

**It has been reported** that three sailors have disappeared.

SUBJECT +  
PASSIVE REPORTING VERB

INFINITIVE CLAUSE

**The race is known** to be extremely dangerous.

"THERE" +  
PASSIVE REPORTING VERB

"TO BE / TO HAVE BEEN"

**There are said** to be at least 20 boats in the search party.



## 42.2 MATCH THE BEGINNINGS OF THE SENTENCES TO THE CORRECT ENDINGS

Unfortunately, it was announced

① There are thought to be more than

② Maria Callas is believed by many

③ The escaped criminal is not thought

④ It is hoped

⑤ The damage is expected

to cost more than \$50,000 to repair.

that many new jobs will be created.

6000 languages in the world.

that 500 employees would lose their jobs.

to be a dangerous threat to society.

to have been the most talented singer ever.

